

INTERVIEW PREPARATION GUIDE

Appraisal Support Specialist — Class Valuation, Ahmedabad

Compiled from classvaluation.com · June 2026

1. Company Overview

What is Class Valuation?

Class Valuation is one of the largest Appraisal Management Companies (AMC) in the United States. Founded in 2009 as *Class Appraisal*, it has grown rapidly and now operates a trusted panel of nearly **20,000 independent appraisers across all 50 states**. Headquartered in Troy, Michigan, the company's stated mission is to "*Accelerate appraisals. Honestly.*" — combining speed, transparency, and accuracy in the residential mortgage appraisal process.

<i>Founded</i>	2009 (as Class Appraisal)
<i>HQ</i>	2600 Bellingham Dr #100, Troy, MI 48083
<i>Appraiser Panel</i>	~20,000 independent appraisers — all 50 states
<i>Avg. Turnaround</i>	8-day average (digital products cut this by 50%)
<i>SOC Certification</i>	SOC 2 Type 2 certified
<i>India Operations</i>	CVAL office in Ahmedabad, Gujarat (your location)
<i>Tagline</i>	"Unmatched coverage. Unrivalled service."

Role in the Mortgage Ecosystem

When a borrower applies for a home loan, federal regulations require an independent property appraisal to confirm the home's market value. Lenders are not permitted to order appraisals directly; they must go through a neutral AMC like Class Valuation. Class acts as the **middleman** between:

- **Lenders / Banks / Credit Unions** — who need fast, accurate valuations to approve or deny loans.
- **Independent Appraisers** — licensed professionals who physically inspect properties.
- **Borrowers / Homeowners** — whose loan timelines depend on how fast the appraisal is completed.

2. Products & Services Portfolio

Appraisal Offerings (Core)

Product	Description
Traditional Appraisal (1004 etc.)	Full in-person inspection by a licensed appraiser. GSE-standard forms.
Digital Appraisal	Uses INvision Capture® + 3D imaging; 50% faster turn times than traditional.
Hybrid Appraisal	Appraiser does desktop analysis; property data collected separately by PDC.
Inspection-Based Waiver	Waives full appraisal using rich property data; GSE-approved.
Property Data Advantage (PDA)	AI-assisted data collection for next-generation collateral insights.

Alternative Valuations

Product	What It Is
AVM (Automated Valuation Model)	Algorithm-driven property value estimate — no human inspection.
BPO (Broker Price Opinion)	Real estate broker provides market-based value opinion.
AVM + PCR	AVM combined with a Property Condition Report from a field agent.
Class Evaluation	Desk-based evaluation using MLS data and property records.
Limited Desktop	Appraiser-led desktop assessment with limited data sources.
Borrower-Led Inspection (BLI)	Homeowner captures photos via app; appraiser completes report remotely.
Class Valuation Analysis (CVA)	Advanced analytics/data product for collateral risk assessment.
CVUE	Class Valuation's flagship unified evaluation engine — combines data, AI, and human review.

Proprietary Technology Stack

Tool	Purpose
INvision Capture®	Mobile app for 3D property capture + ANSI-compliant floor plans.
INvision Desktop®	Dashboard for appraisers to drag-and-drop data into reports.
Class INtelligence	AI/bot engine — runs 200+ rules to QC appraisals automatically.
Property Fingerprint	Transparent property data report combining all collected data.
AppraisalScope	Order management SaaS platform (lender/broker login portal).
Class Marketplace (CMP)	Next-gen order management portal for clients, brokers & vendors.

3. Clients & Market Segments

By Segment	By Role
Centralized Banking	Lenders
Wholesale Lending / TPO	Brokers
Distributed Retail Lending	Appraisers (panel)
Credit Unions (Class Union)	Loan Officers
Private Lending (Appraisal Nation)	Underwriters
Home Equity / HELOC	Servicers & Realtors

Class Union is the dedicated credit union division. **Appraisal Nation** (acquired) and **Bluebird Valuation** (acquired) are sister brands serving private lending and distributed retail channels respectively. **Incenter Appraisal Management** was also acquired in 2023.

4. Leadership Team (Key Names to Know)

Name	Title	Key Note
John Fraas	CEO	Day-to-day operations; growth through innovation.
Chris Flynn	COO	Promoted Jan 2026. Former Head of Product at First American D&A. Leads ops + data inn
Dan Busch	CFO	25+ yrs financial leadership; guided Continental Services through 5x growth.

Jonathan Willen	CRO	20+ yrs mortgage sector; drives revenue growth strategies.
Kaushal Shah	CTO	25+ yrs IT leadership; MBA NewsLink 2025 Tech All-Star. Leads digital transformation.
Jon Tallinger	Chief Growth Officer	First employee (2009); led 250%+ growth since 2016.
Tim Staudenmaier	EVP Product Dev.	Former Fannie Mae Collateral Strategy; designed Collateral Underwriter.
Cristy Conolly	EVP Quality Control	Certified residential appraiser 20+ yrs; HousingWire 2025 Insider.
Brian Kopko	EVP Engineering	25+ yrs tech leadership; SaaS, cloud-native, AI platforms.
John Dingeman	Chief Appraiser	Former President of NAA; certified in 12 states.

Tip: Your role reports to the SVP of Operations – CVAL. Make sure you know who holds that title by checking LinkedIn before your interview. The CVAL (Class Valuation) Ahmedabad office is the India operations hub.

5. Understanding Your Role: Appraisal Support Specialist

The Order Lifecycle — What You Will Manage

Every mortgage appraisal order passes through a pipeline. Your job is to keep orders moving through that pipeline proactively (before problems arise) and reactively (resolving issues as they come). There are **three key parties** in every order:

- **Class Valuation** — your employer, responsible for quality and compliance.
- **The Appraiser** — independent licensed professional performing the inspection.
- **The Client** — the lender, broker, or bank that ordered the appraisal.

Core Daily Activities

Activity	What It Means in Practice
Queue Review	Log into AppraisalScope / CMP and work through your assigned queue of open orders.
Proactive Outreach	Contact appraisers before a deadline is missed (e.g., schedule confirmation, status updates).
Reactive Resolution	Handle inbound messages, client complaints, revision requests, or appraiser issues.
Liaison Role	Relay messages between appraiser and client without compromising appraiser independence (AIR).
Order Management	Ensure each order follows Class, GSE, client, and state-specific requirements.
KPI Tracking	Log your actions so supervisors can measure quality and turn-time performance.
Escalation	Know when to escalate to Senior Manager or QC team vs. handle independently.

Key Industry Terms You Must Know

AMC	Appraisal Management Company — intermediary between lenders & appraisers.
GSE	Government-Sponsored Entity (Fannie Mae, Freddie Mac) — set the rules for conventional loans.
AIR	Appraiser Independence Requirements — federal rules preventing lender influence on value.
USPAP	Uniform Standards of Professional Appraisal Practice — ethical standards appraisers must follow.
UAD	Uniform Appraisal Dataset — standardized data format for appraisal reports. UAD 3.6 is the upcoming mandate.
SaaS	Software as a Service — the operating model of AppraisalScope / CMP platforms you'll use daily.
KPI	Key Performance Indicator — your quality and speed metrics (e.g., orders cleared per day, revision rate).
1004 Form	Standard single-family residential appraisal form used by Fannie Mae/Freddie Mac.
Turn Time	Days from order placement to delivery of completed appraisal report.
PIW / IBW	Property Inspection Waiver / Inspection-Based Waiver — GSE programs that waive physical inspections.
BPO	Broker Price Opinion — a lower-cost alternative to a full appraisal.

6. Company Culture & Values

What Class Valuation Looks For

The JD's "Who You Are" section is their culture in plain English. Use this to shape your interview answers:

Passionate & Mission-Driven

They want people who want to make a positive impact, not just fill a seat. Show enthusiasm for the industry and the company's modernization mission.

Curious & Inquisitive

They explicitly want you to ask 'why', not just 'how'. Demonstrate intellectual curiosity about the mortgage/appraisal industry.

Independent Worker

You'll manage queues with little micro-management. Give examples of self-directed work.

Roll Up Your Sleeves

Willingness to do unglamorous, repetitive queue-management tasks. Don't oversell yourself as only a strategist — show you're hands-on.

Analytical Problem-Solver

Each order can have unique complications. Show you enjoy solving novel problems logically.

Awards & Recognition

- Top Workplaces 2021 — Detroit Free Press.
- SOC 2 Type 2 Certified — enterprise-grade data security.
- HousingWire 2025 Insider: Cristy Conolly (Quality Control AI integration).
- MBA NewsLink 2025 Tech All-Star: Kaushal Shah (CTO).
- HW Marketing Leader 2026: Holly Shipley (CMO).

7. Industry Context & Current Trends

The Big Trends to Know

Appraisal Modernization	Fannie Mae & Freddie Mac are actively pushing for faster, more tech-driven appraisals. Class is at the forefront of this shift with digital and hybrid products that reduce turn times by 50%.
UAD 3.6 Mandate	A new mandatory appraisal data format is rolling out across the US mortgage industry. Class is running dedicated webinars and resource hubs to help lenders prepare — this is a major talking point for any operations role.
Appraiser Shortage	The US is facing a shortage of licensed appraisers as older professionals retire. AMCs like Class are critical infrastructure because they efficiently match available appraisers with orders nationwide.
AI in Appraisals	Class INtelligence (their proprietary AI engine) runs 200+ quality-check rules automatically. Understanding how AI is changing the QC workflow is directly relevant to your support role.
Bias Mitigation & Equity	Federal regulators are focused on appraisal bias. Class actively promotes bias mitigation and fair appraisal practices — a values-aligned topic to mention in your interview.

8. Likely Interview Questions & Model Answers

Tip: Use the STAR method (Situation, Task, Action, Result) for behavioral questions. Weave in Class Valuation's language: 'pipeline', 'KPIs', 'three-party communication', 'queue management'.

Q: Tell me about Class Valuation. What do you know about us?

A: Class Valuation is one of the nation's largest AMCs, founded in 2009, with a panel of nearly 20,000 independent appraisers across all 50 states. What excites me most is your mission to modernize the appraisal process — reducing turn times by 50% with digital appraisals, using AI via Class INtelligence, and now preparing lenders for the UAD 3.6 mandate. The Ahmedabad CVAL office plays a critical role in fulfillment operations, which is exactly where I want to contribute.

Q: What does an Appraisal Support Specialist do?

A: The role sits at the center of the three-party communication between Class Valuation, independent appraisers, and lender clients. Day-to-day, it involves proactively working through order queues, notifying parties of updates, managing messages, ensuring compliance with client and GSE requirements, and tracking performance against KPI targets. It's a mix of operational excellence and communication skills.

Q: Why do you want to work in the appraisal or mortgage industry?

A: The residential mortgage industry directly impacts millions of families' ability to buy homes. I'm drawn to a role where my attention to detail and communication directly supports that outcome. Class Valuation's commitment to speed and accuracy — and its leadership in digital appraisals — makes it a particularly exciting employer at a time when the industry is transforming.

Q: How do you manage a high-volume queue or multiple competing priorities?

A: I use a combination of categorization and time-boxing. First, I segment tasks by urgency — deadlines, escalations, and proactive outreach — and address the highest-impact items first. I also log all actions consistently so there's a clear audit trail, which is important for the KPI tracking this role requires.

Q: What is Appraiser Independence, and why does it matter?

A: Appraiser Independence Requirements (AIR) are federal rules mandating that appraisers form their opinions without pressure or influence from lenders. As a support specialist, I act as a neutral relay between the appraiser and client. This means I must be careful never to convey the client's desired value or suggest the appraiser change their opinion — only factual, permissible communications are allowed.

Q: Describe a time you identified and corrected an error before it became a bigger problem.

A: In my previous role, while reviewing a batch of processed records, I noticed a data entry inconsistency that would have caused downstream reporting errors. I flagged it immediately, documented the pattern, and worked with the team to correct the batch before it was submitted. This connects directly to the 'meticulous attention to detail for identifying errors and omissions' requirement in the job description.

Q: What tools and software are you comfortable with?

A: I'm proficient in Microsoft Office Suite, and I've worked with SaaS order management platforms — similar to AppraisalScope and the Class Marketplace (CMP) platforms Class Valuation uses. I pick up new systems quickly and am particularly comfortable with high-volume data entry environments.

Q: Do you have any questions for us?

A: Yes — a few: (1) What does a typical day in the CVAL Ahmedabad office look like for this team? (2) How are KPIs structured — is it primarily turn-time-based or quality-score-based? (3) How closely does the Ahmedabad team coordinate with the Troy HQ operations team? These questions show you understand the role and are already thinking like an employee.

9. Key Talking Points to Weave In

These are phrases and facts from the company's own website that signal you've done thorough research:

- "I noticed Class Valuation recently partnered with Makena to help appraisers prepare for UAD 3.6 — that tells me the company is genuinely invested in the appraiser ecosystem, not just clients."
- "The Class INtelligence engine running 200+ automated QC rules is impressive — it means my work as a support specialist is augmented by technology, which lets me focus on the more nuanced human communication."
- "I understand the Ahmedabad office is the CVAL operations center, and I see this role as part of the fulfillment backbone that makes Class's fast turnaround times possible."
- "Your digital appraisal workflow — from INvision Capture through to the Property Fingerprint — is a genuinely differentiated process. I'd love to understand how a support specialist interacts with appraisers at each of those stages."
- "I read that Class is SOC 2 Type 2 certified — data privacy and process integrity clearly matter here, which aligns with how seriously I take accurate record-keeping."

10. Quick-Reference Cheat Sheet

Item	Detail
Full Company Name	Class Valuation (formerly Class Appraisal)
Founded	2009
HQ	Troy, Michigan, USA
India Office	Ahmedabad, Gujarat (CVAL)
CEO	John Fraas
COO	Chris Flynn (promoted Jan 2026)
CTO	Kaushal Shah
Chief Appraiser	John Dingeman
Your Supervisor	SVP of Operations – CVAL
Appraiser Panel Size	~20,000 across all 50 states
Avg. Turn Time	8 days (50% faster with digital)
Key Platform	AppraisalScope + Class Marketplace (CMP)
AI Tool	Class INtelligence (200+ QC rules)
Mobile Capture App	INvision Capture®
Key Compliance Rule	AIR — Appraiser Independence Requirements
Industry Standards Body	GSE (Fannie Mae & Freddie Mac)
Upcoming Industry Event	UAD 3.6 Mandate (prepare now)
Culture Keyword	"Accelerate appraisals. Honestly."

Awards	SOC 2 Type 2; DFP Top Workplaces 2021; HW Insiders
Recent Acquisitions	Appraisal Nation, Bluebird Valuation, Incenter Appraisal Mgmt.

Compiled from classvaluation.com sitemap links — June 2026 | For personal interview preparation only.